

Expanding the nominal in English ACC- and POSS-*ing* nominalizations*

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1. Introduction

This work primarily concerns English ACC- and POSS-*ing* gerunds, as in (1).

- (1) [**Him/His** quickly running the marathon] surprised us. ACC-*ing*/POSS-*ing*

These and similar “clausal nominalizations” have been of interest since the seminal discussion of Lees (1960) and Chomsky (1970) due to their mixed verbal and nominal properties. For instance, ACC- and POSS-*ing* gerunds have accusative-marked objects and take adverbial modification, like verbs, but they distribute like nouns, appearing (usually) in Case positions (Reuland 1983, Abney 1987; see as well Pires 2001, 2006, 2007).

To capture their mixed properties, clausal nominalizations are often analyzed as verbal projections with nominal structure layered on top (Reuland 1983, Abney 1987, Borsley and Kornfilt 2000, Alexiadou et al. 2011, Kornfilt and Whitman 2011). This ‘phrasal layering’ approach (to use a term from Wood 2023), though far from the only view (for overviews, see Alexiadou et al. 2007, Kornfilt and Whitman 2011), raises two questions regarding the syntax of clausal nominalizations: how verbal and how nominal are these constructions?

The former question receives considerable attention. There are many analyses of ACC- and POSS-*ing* gerunds, but the consensus is that both project extensive clausal structure (at least to where subjects are introduced, but often higher; those cited above, a.m.o.). The current work, however, concerns nominal structure. The received wisdom is that clausal gerunds are structurally not very nominal, as they lack many nominal properties (those cited above; also Iordăchioaia and Soare 2008, Alexiadou et al. 2011, Iordăchioaia 2020). This makes particular sense under a view in which nominalizations are ‘mixed extended projections’ (Borsley and Kornfilt 2000): single abstract functional sequences whose limited positions are split between a verbal and nominal component (assuming ‘parallelism’ between domains; Chomsky 1970, Abney 1987, Grimshaw 1990, Szabolcsi 1994).

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Under this view, clausal nominalizations lack nominal properties precisely because they exhibit so many verbal ones: their functional spine is mostly verbal, leaving little room for anything nominal. These accounts predict that how much nominal structure a nominalization exhibits is directly dependent on the size of the verbal structure being nominalized — a nominalized TP, for instance, should bear very little nominal structure. Nominalization as a syntactic process would also therefore be dependent on the structure being nominalized; different nominal functional material will be recruited to nominalize differently sized (verbal) structures as the lower slots of the single abstract functional sequence are filled in with their verbal, rather than nominal, versions (see, e.g., Alexiadou 2020, Iordăchioaia 2020).

I defend here an alternative analysis of clausal nominalization, where nominalization is a process independent of the size of the structure being nominalized. I argue that nominalizations are not single functional sequences split between a nominal and clausal component. I instead pursue a Distributed Morphology-aligned view that (re)categorization is uniformly governed by categorizing heads like *n* and *v*. Heads like *n* may combine with more or less arbitrarily-sized structures and may then project a new functional spine of their own category. Such a ‘stacked extended projection’ view makes the opposite prediction as a mixed extended projection view: there is no necessary trading relation between clausal and nominal syntax. Nominalized clauses, no matter how far up the verbal sequence they project, have full nominal spines and therefore display many nominal properties.

Concretely, I propose that ACC- and POSS-*ing* gerunds are the sort of structure predicted by a stacked (not mixed) extended projection view. Both gerunds contain a full nominal spine on top of a large clausal one. Motivating this are novel empirical observations concerning “measured gerunds”. Consider, first, this interpretive contrast (2–3): ACC-*ing* gerunds are acceptable in (2–3), but POSS-*ing* gerunds are only felicitous in (3).

- (2) *Context*: Kim is in a talent show. Each contestant gets exactly 10 minutes to perform a talent of their choosing. Kim delivers an exceptional piano performance. You say:
- a. ^{OK}[**Ten minutes of Kim playing the piano**] impressed the judges. ACC-*ing*
 - b. # [**Ten minutes of Kim’s playing the piano**] impressed the judges. POSS-*ing*
- (3) *Context*: Same as above, but contestants get 15 minutes. Kim’s performance also does not go as well, but the final 10 minutes are quite good. You tell your friend:
- a. ^{OK}[**Ten minutes of Kim playing the piano**] impressed the judges. ACC-*ing*
 - b. ^{OK}[**Ten minutes of Kim’s playing the piano**] impressed the judges. POSS-*ing*

I draw the following parallels: measured ACC-*ing* gerunds pattern like pseudopartitives (4a), merely picking out some quantity of a substance or event, while measured POSS-*ing* gerunds pattern with partitives (4b), necessarily denoting a strict subpart of a larger whole.

- (4) a. Nick put **two cups of cherries** into the pie. *pseudopartitive*
 b. Nick put **two cups of the cherries** into the pie. *partitive*

Extending classic and recent work on the syntax of measurements (e.g., Selkirk 1977, Toquero-Pérez 2023), I argue the behavior of English gerunds in such constructions necessitates an analysis of nominalization which affords them an extensive nominal spine,

independent of the size of the clause being nominalized. The crucial component is that lower nominal functional projections, just above *n*, are required to form a pseudopartitive.

I proceed by reviewing the verbal syntax of gerunds (section 2) and the syntax of measurement (section 3). I then discuss the core proposal (section 4) and conclude (section 5). Reported judgments for the most part reflect my L1 American English intuitions. Particularly contentious examples were verified via informal survey of a dozen other L1 English speakers; when relevant, I provide the count of those who found a sentence acceptable. Nuanced, context-sensitive examples were carefully discussed with fewer correspondents.

2. Background: Verbal syntax

I motivate an updated version of Abney's (1987) account of English gerunds: ACC-*ing* gerunds contain TP, while POSS-*ing* gerunds contain verbal structure only to AspP. Subjects of ACC-*ing* gerunds originate VP-internally, while subjects of POSS-*ing* gerunds originate in the position of possessors (Spec, DP); see Abney (1987) for more detail. The key observation for present purposes is that the subjects' positions results in ACC-*ing* gerunds 'fitting within' a constituent smaller than DP, while POSS-*ing* gerunds must be full DPs.

2.1 Verbal functional structure

In addition to exhibiting evidence of lower verbal functional structure (section 1), both ACC- and POSS-*ing* gerunds have a position for the aspectual auxiliary *have* (Abney 1987), as in (5a). Compare this to the 'POSS-*ing_{of}*' gerund in (5b), which disallows *have*.

- (5) a. Guineve('s) **having** presented a golden cup to Bertrand shocked us.
b. *Guineve's **having/have** presented **of** a golden cup to Bertrand shocked us.
(adapted from Abney 1987:182)

ACC- and POSS-*ing*, but not POSS-*ing_{of}*, gerunds, must have a position to house auxiliaries. For Abney (1987), this is VP. I update this: both gerunds contain verbal structure to AspP.

The gerunds diverge with respect to TP. The main evidence I present surrounds expletive subjects, which are permitted in ACC- (Williams 1975, Reuland 1983) but not POSS-*ing* gerunds (Portner 1992, Pires 2007; *pace* Baker 1985, Abney 1987 who accept (7b)).

- (6) a. You may count on **there** being a lot of trouble tonight. OK = 12/12
b. I'm sad about **it** being certain that she'll quit. OK = 12/12
(adapted from Reuland 1983:109, Baker 1985)
- (7) a. *You may count on **there's** being a lot of trouble tonight. OK = 1/12
b. *I'm sad about **its** being certain that she'll quit. OK = 0/12
(adapted from Baker 1985, Abney 1987:184, Pires 2007:168)

I assume that *there*-expletives originate low and raise to Spec, TP (Hoekstra and Mulder 1990, Moro 1997) and that *it*-expletives are inserted at Spec, TP to satisfy the EPP requirement of T (Chomsky 1981). Both expletives require Spec, TP to be present. The

unavailability of expletives in *POSS-ing* gerunds demonstrates that *POSS-ing* gerunds lack T. Meanwhile, *ACC-ing* gerunds bear a T(P) with an EPP requirement. To summarize, then, *POSS-ing* gerunds contain verbal structure to AspP, and *ACC-ing* gerunds to TP.

2.2 Position and trajectory of the subject

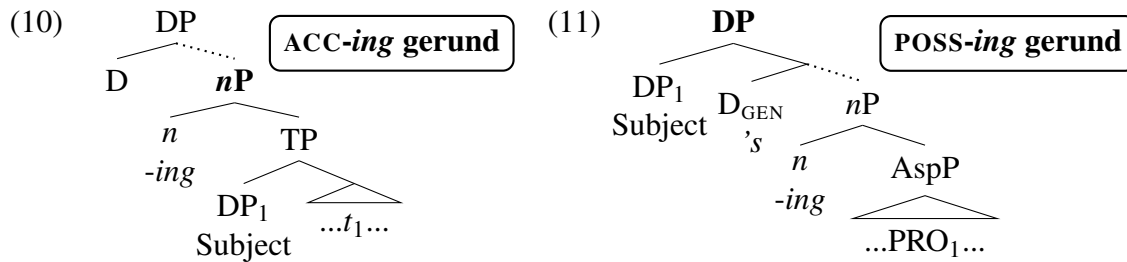
The ‘subjects’ of *ACC-* and *POSS-ing* gerunds pattern differently. Diagnostics concerning the movement trajectory of subjects from Koopman and Sportiche (1991) and McCloskey (1997:204–9) demonstrate that subjects of *ACC-ing* gerunds originate low (like canonical subjects) while subjects of *POSS-ing* gerunds originate high (in the position of possessors).

Idiom chunks (Abney 1987:177) and scopal (non)ambiguities (*pace* Portner 1992:94) can be used to show this, but I omit these for reasons of space. Instead, I discuss data from quantifier float, as, to my knowledge, the contrasts in (8–9) have never been reported.

- (8) ^{OK}{**All**} the children ^{OK}{**all**} having ^{OK}{**all**} failed chemistry surprised us.
(9) ^{OK}{**All**} the children *{**all**}’s *{**all**} having *{**all**} failed chemistry surprised us.

Quantifiers like *all* related to the subject can be separated from the rest of the subject in *ACC-* (8) but not *POSS-ing* gerunds (9). Assuming that such quantifiers can only be stranded in positions that the subject once occupied (Sportiche 1988, McCloskey 1997:205), the above data demonstrates that subjects of *ACC-ing* gerunds originate low (VP-internally) and raise, while the subjects of *POSS-ing* gerunds originate high, in their surface position.

I analyze *ACC-ing* subjects as canonical clausal subjects which raise to Spec, TP (10) and *POSS-ing* subjects as canonical possessors (11).¹ For reasons of simplicity, I choose Spec, DP as the position that possessors occupy (see Myler 2016 for more nuanced discussion). The structures below summarize the analysis so far. I assume *-ing* Lowers (Embick and Noyer 2001, Harizanov and Gribanova 2019) to its surface position postsyntactically.



What is crucial to note moving forward is that the minimal constituent containing all the pronounced material (bolded in the structures above) in each gerund is different. Although I assume both *ACC-* and *POSS-ing* gerunds project to DP, all of the material with overt phonological content in an *ACC-ing* gerund ‘fits within’ *nP*, while just *nP* in a *POSS-ing*

¹The label ‘TP’ in (10) is also a convenience: one only needs a head beyond those in a *POSS-ing* gerund. This ‘T’ is quite peculiar, in any case: it has an EPP requirement, is phonologically null, has little apparent semantic contribution, and assigns accusative. This last property may be unnecessary if English accusative is ‘default’ (Marantz 1992, Schütze 2001, Preminger 2024), but this requires particular analyses of default case. For instance, weak pronoun subjects (*it*) in *ACC-ing* gerunds rules out accounts like Caha’s (2024).

gerund excludes the possessor-subject. The minimal constituent containing all pronounced material in a POSS-*ing* gerund is not *nP* but *DP*, due the subject of POSS-*ing* gerunds being introduced ‘clause-externally’, in the nominal component of the gerund. This difference will become crucial in the analysis of measured gerund constructions, which I turn to now.

3. Analogies between measured gerunds and pseudopartitives and partitives

Assuming a distinct syntax for pseudopartitives and partitives (e.g., Selkirk 1977, Zamparelli 2014, Falco and Zamparelli 2019), I argue the patterning of English measured gerunds supports an analysis in which clausal nominalizations have complete nominal structure.

3.1 Pseudopartitives and partitives

I repeat the puzzle (2–3) from the introduction, in condensed form, below in (12–13).

- (12) *Context*: Kim performs for 10 minutes in a talent show.
a. [Ten minutes of Kim(#’s) playing the piano] impressed the judges.
- (13) *Context*: Kim performs for 15 minutes, but only does well for the last 10 minutes.
a. ^{OK}[Ten minutes of Kim(’s) playing the piano] impressed the judges.

Context (2)/(12) is meant to force the measurement constructions to pick out the entirety of Kim’s performance; in this case, only a measured ACC-*ing* gerund is felicitous. Context (3)/(13) forces the measurement constructions to pick out a proper subpart of Kim’s performance; in this case, either a measured ACC- or POSS-*ing* gerund is licit.

In this way, measured ACC-*ing* gerunds parallel pseudopartitives (14a) and measured POSS-*ing* gerunds partitives (14b). By pseudopartitives, I refer to constructions which (in English) measure a bare plural count or bare mass noun (see Selkirk 1977, Falco and Zamparelli 2019, Seržant 2021). By partitives, I refer to measurements of full *DPs*, subject to the Partitive Constraint (Ladusaw 1982, de Hoop 1997, Barker 1998; see Ionin et al. 2006).

- (14) a. Nick put **two cups of cherries** into the pie. *pseudopartitive*
b. Nick put **two cups of the cherries** into the pie. *partitive*

Like measured ACC-*ing* gerunds, the pseudopartitive in (14a) could refer to all the contextually relevant cherries. Like measured POSS-*ing* gerunds, the partitive in (14b) must refer to a proper subpart of some quantity of cherries.

I follow Selkirk (1977) and assume distinct structures for partitives and pseudopartitives (see also Toquero-Pérez 2023, whose work this discussion is also based upon). The key difference is that pseudopartitives correspond to one *DP* but partitives to two. From this, it follows that the measured substance in a pseudopartitive is a nominal projection smaller than *DP*, while in a partitive an entire *DP* is measured. Further, in partitives, *of* is a true preposition, but in pseudopartitives, it is the exponent of a nominal functional head.

The account requires an articulated nominal functional sequence; for concreteness, I adopt Svenonius’s (2008) decomposition of *DP* presented in (15) (see also Ott 2011).

- (15) Dem > Art > Num > UNIT > Pl/SORT > *n* > $\sqrt{\text{ROOT}}$ (Svenonius 2008:27)

The head Pl/SORT encodes the mass/count distinction and houses plural morphology. UNIT introduces quantizing classifiers; in English, these are the classifiers necessary to, for instance, count mass nouns (Chierchia 1998a, 1998b). Num introduces numerals (#Ps) in its specifier. I collapse the two positions for determiners Dem and Art into D for simplicity.

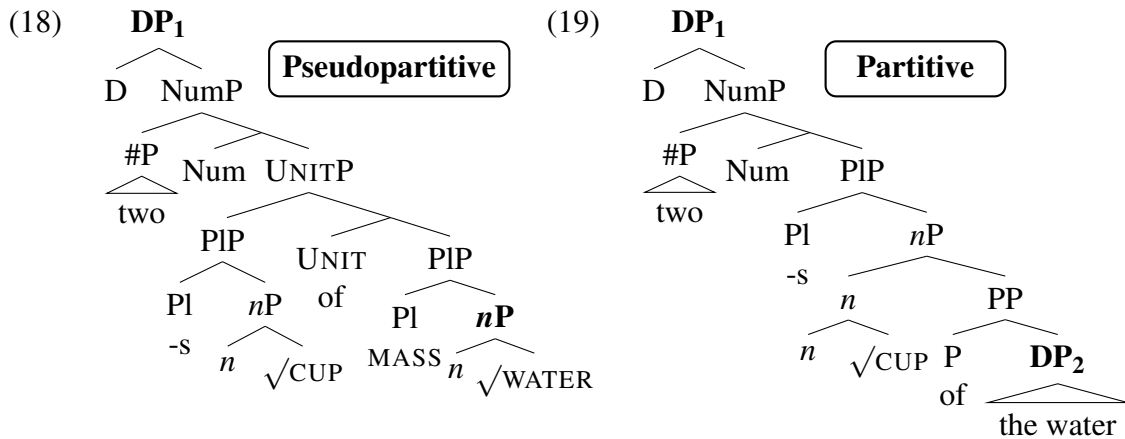
I assume *of* exponents a UNIT head which selects for mass or plural count PIPs in pseudopartitive constructions. *Of* introduces the measuring noun (e.g., *cup*) in its specifier (reminiscent of Mon; Schwarzschild 2006). Specifically, measuring nouns are introduced in Spec, UNITP as PIPs, rather than full DPs, to capture that these measure terms do not behave as full DPs (Corver 1998:226). Measure terms cannot host another numeral (in their own Spec, NumP) nor postnominal PP-modifiers, assumed to be DP-level adjuncts (16).

- (16) a. *two [three bottles] of wine
b. *two [bottles with long necks] of wine (Corver 1998:226)

Measure terms can, however, be modified by substantive adjectives (17). These are analyzed as PIP modifiers (Svenonius 2008), so the measure term in Spec, UNITP is as large as PIP.

- (17) two [big expensive bottles] of wine

These considerations lead to these structures for pseudopartitives (18) and partitives (19):



I intend this not as a definitive analysis but rather a concrete update to Selkirk's (1977) proposal: pseudopartitives correspond to a single DP and measure a nominal projection smaller than DP; partitives correspond to two DPs and measure a full DP. Crucially, then, the pseudopartitive measure material is housed low within the nominal projection of the measured substance itself. To form a pseudopartitive, lower nominal functional structure must be present. This becomes crucial in the analysis of the measured gerunds (section 4).

3.2 ACC-*ing* gerunds are to pseudopartitives as POSS-*ing* gerunds are to partitives

Before extending the structures in (18–19) to measured gerunds, I first wish to expand the parallels between measured ACC-*ing* gerunds and pseudopartitives and between measured

POSS-*ing* gerunds and partitives. This section details two diagnostics which distinguish pseudopartitives and partitives (see Selkirk 1977 for additional ones) and demonstrates that they also distinguish ACC- and POSS-*ing* measurement constructions. My purpose here is to simply deepen the analogies between measurement constructions; I do not intend to provide full analyses of either of these diagnostics.

First, certain quantifiers are only possible in partitives (see, e.g., Selkirk 1977, Ladusaw 1982, Shin 2016); these include *some*, *most*, and fractional quantifiers like *half* (20).²

- (20) a. *some/most/half of cherries b. some/most/half of the cherries

The gerunds behave as expected if measured ACC-*ing* gerunds are pseudopartitives and measured POSS-*ing* gerunds partitives: *some*, *most*, and fractions are unacceptable in measured ACC-*ing* constructions (21a) but acceptable with POSS-*ing* gerunds (21b).

- (21) a. *The judges based their decision on **some/most/half** of him playing the piano.
b. The judges based their decision on **some/most/half** of his playing the piano.

I leave this unanalyzed but reemphasize the parallels these contrasts begin to establish.³

The next pattern has to do with the behavior of *of* in comparative pseudogapping, which refers to a process in which some material (the ‘remnant’) is evacuated from VP before VP-ellipsis occurs (Jayaseelan 1990); the ‘comparative’ part plays a role in licensing ellipsis, in the first place (Kennedy 2002, Thoms 2016). Selkirk (1977:308) notes that in such constructions, *of* can be omitted from pseudopartitives (22a) but not partitives (22b).

- (22) a. I met a larger number of high schoolers than I did (**of**) college students.
b. I met a larger number of **the** high schoolers than I did ***(of) the** college students.

This is taken as evidence that *of* is of different status in partitives and pseudopartitives; whatever it is, it can be freely dropped from a pseudopartitive remnant in this construction, but *of* cannot be dropped from a partitive remnant in the same environment. It would be difficult to account for this if pseudopartitives and partitives had the exact same underlying structures, but we can begin to get a handle on these facts assuming, along with Selkirk (1977), that the two measurement constructions have distinct syntaxes.

For Selkirk (1977), the facts in (22) stem from pseudopartitive *of* being inserted via a late transformation. For a more modern take, I consider Thoms’s (2016) discussion of similar cases of (non-measurement) PP-remnants in comparative pseudogapping (23).

- (23) Rab bought more pictures of his dog than he did **of his cat**. (Thoms 2016:288)

This is not the appropriate venue for a full treatment of these facts, and so I merely sketch Thoms’s (2016) account and what else would be required to cover (22). Thoms (2016) analyzes (23) as involving [_{DP} *pictures* [_{PP} *of his cat*]] evacuating the VP in the *than*-standard clause. VP ellipsis then applies. Only the PP, and not the entire DP, surfaces due to

²See Ionin et al. (2006) for important discussion on (in part) fractions in partitives; the view undertaken there derives differences between pseudopartitives and partitives in semantic rather than syntactic fashion.

³I believe this contrast is semantic in nature (see section 5 for some forward-looking discussion).

pictures being deleted via ‘comparative subdeletion’ as outlined by Kennedy (2002). Like other elliptical operations, comparative subdeletion is partially governed by constraints on ‘recoverability’ (Fiengo and Lasnik 1974), which requires deleted material to stand in a grammatical identity relation with some antecedent.⁴ What is missing is an explanation as to why *of* cannot also be deleted from the remnant of a partitive like (22b) but can in a pseudopartitive like (22a); I do not attempt to fill in these missing components here.⁵

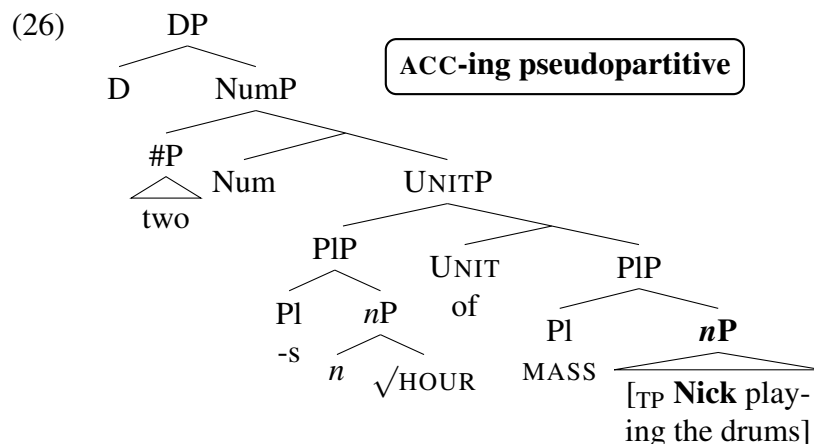
The exact details of (pseudo)partitive comparative pseudogapping notwithstanding, note that, strikingly, measured ACC-*ing* gerunds continue to pattern with pseudopartitives and measured POSS-*ing* gerunds with partitives. The former allow *of* to be dropped from the remnant of comparative pseudogapping constructions (24) while the latter do not (25).

- (24) a. ^{OK}Last week, the music teacher heard more hours of Ty playing the drums than the drama teacher did **of Lee** practicing the scene. OK = 12/12
 b. ? Last week, the music teacher heard more hours of Ty playing the drums than the drama teacher did **Lee** practicing the scene. OK = 7/12
- (25) a. ? Last week, the music teacher heard more hours of Ty’s playing the drums than the drama teacher did **of Lee’s** practicing the scene. OK = 7/12
 b. *Last week, the music teacher heard more hours of Ty’s playing the drums than the drama teacher did **Lee’s** practicing the scene. OK = 1/12

I take this contrast to be highly suggestive that measured ACC-*ing* gerunds ought to be analyzed as pseudopartitives and measured POSS-*ing* gerunds as partitives; I now do so.

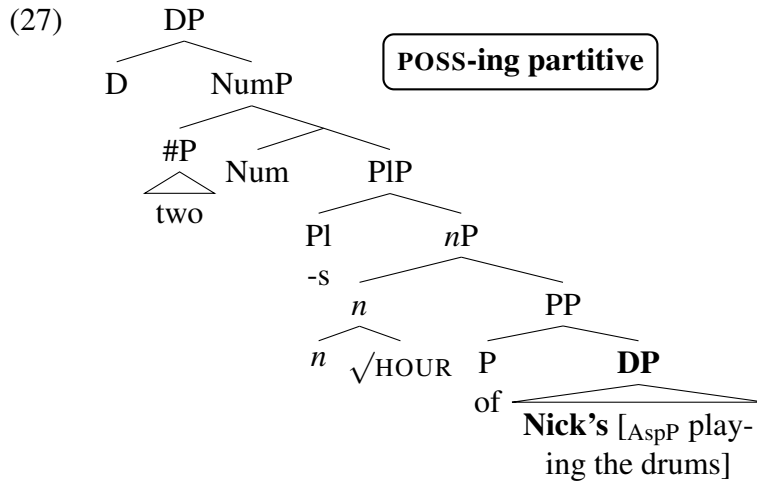
4. Proposal: applying measure syntax to gerunds

I directly apply the assumed syntax for pseudopartitives and partitives to measured ACC- (26) and POSS-*ing* gerunds (27), respectively, arriving at the following:



⁴See Thoms (2016:288–92) for arguments against (PP-)extraposition being involved in pseudogapping.

⁵Without *of*, what remains from a partitive is a DP, while in a pseudopartitive what is left is smaller than DP (a PIP). It is possible some appeal could be made to the different licensing requirements of DPs versus PIPs: perhaps *of* is the only thing available to license a stranded DP but *of* is not necessary to license a PIP.



We have observed that measured ACC-*ing* gerunds pattern as pseudopartitives, and that pseudopartitives require the measured substance to have an articulated nominal functional spine (in order to house, for instance, pseudopartitive *of* in UNIT and the measuring noun in Spec, UNITP). The consequence of this is (26): ACC-*ing* gerunds, despite being nominalized TPs, must have extensive nominal functional structure in order to form pseudopartitives. This makes ACC-*ing* pseudopartitives just the type of structure predicted not to exist by a mixed extended projection view of nominalization, in which verbal and nominal material strictly trade off with one another. Having both extensive verbal and nominal functional structure, ACC-*ing* pseudopartitives are more consistent with a stacked extended projection view of nominalizations, where the amount of nominal material contained within a nominalization is independent of how much verbal structure is projected.

Measured POSS-*ing* gerunds (27), on the other hand, do not provide much insight into the lower nominal domain of the gerund itself. Since POSS-*ing* gerunds are complete DPs, they pattern as such, and form partitives as above. In principle, this is possible regardless of whether POSS-*ing* gerunds also have lower nominal functional structure beneath D. From just these two data points, then, we cannot conclude that nominalization is independent of what sort of verbal structure is being nominalized. After all, what we see is that nominalized TPs (ACC-*ing* gerunds) are *n*P and therefore form pseudopartitives when measured, while nominalized AspPs (POSS-*ing* gerunds) are DPs and therefore form partitives when measured. If nominalization is uniform and independent of what is being nominalized, we expect that nominalized AspPs can be *n*P (forming pseudopartitives) and that nominalized TPs can be DP (forming partitives). I now present instantiations of such constructions.

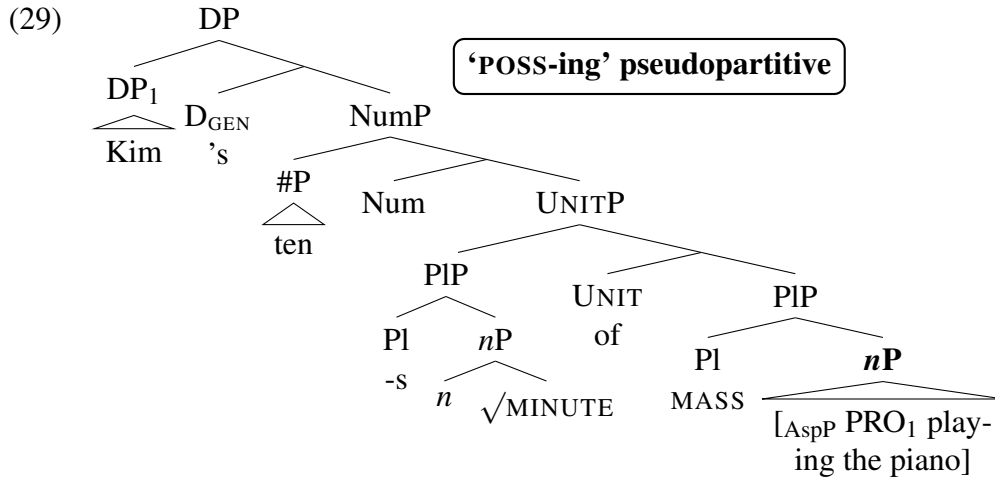
4.1 AspP nominalizations patterning as *n*P and forming pseudopartitives

Starting with *n*P nominalizations of AspP, I first note why we have observed that measured POSS-*ing* gerunds only form partitives thus far. The structural height of the possessor in Spec, DP (or some similar high nominal position) is above where pseudopartitive measure material is housed (lower, in Spec, UNITP). Recall, as well, that pseudopartitive measure material is housed in the functional spine of the measured substance itself — in this case, that is the same functional spine as hosts the possessor. The prediction, then, is that were

one to make a pseudopartitive out of a “POSS-*ing*” gerund, the possessor must appear external to (before) the pseudopartitive measure material, as in (28).⁶

- (28) *Context*: As in (2); Kim performs for 10 minutes exactly.
a. [**Kim’s** [ten minutes of playing the piano]] impressed the judges.

Note that unlike the POSS-*ing* partitives we have observed before, the construction in (28) does not require that it refer to a strict subpart of the measured event (in fact, it must not; consider a context where Kim plays longer than 10 minutes). That is, the construction above is a *nP* nominalized AspP pseudopartitive, with the following structure (29).



This sort of structure is straightforwardly predicted by the stacked extended projection view: nominalization occurs uniformly via *n*, and so nominalized AspPs have extensive nominal functional structure, allowing them to form pseudopartitives.

4.2 TP nominalizations patterning as DPs and forming partitives

I now turn to constructions which demonstrate that TP nominalizations can pattern as DPs and form partitives. Recall that partitives are measurements of full DPs. An ACC-*ing* gerund preceded by either a determiner like *the* or a possessor (in addition to the accusative subject of the gerund itself) could straightforwardly be analyzed as a TP nominalization containing nominal material up to DP. The traditional observation is that this is simply impossible; these are the sorts of properties clausal nominalizations like ACC-*ing* gerunds lack, motivating the sorts of mixed extended projection analyses discussed in the introduction. My observation, however, is that given a sufficiently rich and supportive context, ACC-*ing* gerunds do actually accept determiners and possessors (30), contrary to this classic claim.⁷

⁶We can confirm that such constructions involve AspP by noting that they support the auxiliary *have*.

i. My eight years of **having** run track and field competitively left me with bad ankles.

⁷These contexts are inspired by Grimm and McNally’s (2016) discussion of ‘*the*-VP_{ing}’ gerunds. They note that such constructions are especially felicitous when what they call ‘event-type’ reference is supported. I take the constructions discussed there to be more or less AspP nominalizations taking non-possessor determiner strategies (that is, they have the verbal component of a POSS-*ing* gerund, just without the possessor).

- (30) *Context*: A bar hosts a popular competition where people reenact a famous movie scene. This week, the scene is one from *The Shining* where Jack Nicholson breaks down a door and yells, “Here’s Johnny!”. Bill is the best actor and wins easily.
- a. The judges watched [DP **every** [_{nP}[TP Jack breaking down the door]]] before deciding on a winner.
 - b. [DP **One/Some/A** [_{nP}[TP Jack breaking down the door]]] was much better than the other performances.
 - c. [DP **The** [_{nP}[TP Jack breaking down the door]] **that won**] was Bill’s.
 - d. [DP **Bill’s (best)** [_{nP}[TP Jack breaking down the door]]] won first prize.

Note that these examples are somewhat surprising under a mixed extended projection view, but they are predicted straightforwardly by the stacked extended projection account at hand: there is no necessary trade-off between verbal and nominal properties. Despite being nominalized TPs, and despite exhibiting extensive clausal properties, it is not the case that ACC-*ing* gerunds are completely ‘defective’ nominals. In the right contexts, not only do ACC-*ing* gerunds permit determiners and possessors (30), but they also accept certain nominal modification strategies. In (30c), the ACC-*ing* gerund supports a restrictive relative clause (*that won*), and in (30d), the gerund accepts adjectival modification via the superlative adjective *best*. The mix of nominal properties displayed here is unexpected if nominalizations of large verbal structures are necessarily completely deficient in nominal properties. The examples in (30) demonstrate TP nominalizations can behave quite nominally.

To return to fill out our measurement paradigm, though, note that the forms in (30) are all reasonably analyzed as DPs due to the presence of determiners (in D) or possessors (housed in Spec, DP), and, as expected, when measured, they form partitives (31).

- (31) The judges saw [DP **thirty seconds** [_{PP} of [DP the Jack breaking down the door that ended up winning] before deciding it was the best.

The sentence in (31) is felicitous only if the performance being measured lasted longer than 30 seconds; it is infelicitous if the player performs the entire scene in exactly 30 seconds. ACC-*ing* gerunds, then, do not necessarily form pseudopartitives just as POSS-*ing* gerunds do not necessarily form partitives; nominalized TPs and nominalized AspPs in English can appear in either pseudopartitive or partitive constructions, suggesting that nominalizations uniformly project extensive nominal functional structure, independent of the verbal structure being nominalized.

5. Conclusion

I propose in this work that syntactic recategorization is a uniform syntactic process: verbal structures, no matter how large, are always nominalized by a categorizing head *n*, which then projects a full nominal functional sequence. I present data which are surprising under a view in which nominalizations only project a single abstract functional spine with a limited number of functional positions. Such a view predicts that nominalizations of large verbal structures (say, of TPs) should be necessarily defective in nominal structure (and, therefore, deficient in nominal properties), but I observe that English clausal gerunds, despite

being nominalizations of large verbal structures (AspP and TP), display extensive nominal properties. Among these are their ability to form pseudopartitives, which require projection of lower nominal functional material, as well as their ability to appear with a range of determiners and nominal modification strategies (e.g., restrictive relative clauses). I claim, then, that nominalization is a syntactic process independent of what is being nominalized.

Some issues remain, however. For one thing, it remains true that ACC- and POSS-*ing* gerunds do not exhibit a full suite of nominal properties, as might have been expected if they indeed project a complete nominal functional sequence. For instance, the gerunds are not straightforwardly compatible with most adjectives; above, I observe that superlative adjectives like *best* are acceptable with gerunds, but note that the adjectival correlates of manner adverbs (e.g., *quick*, *loud*, etc.) are unacceptable as modifiers of clausal gerunds. Separately, the account here relies on specific assumptions about the structure of measurement constructions in English — others have analyzed the distinctions discussed here not as syntactic differences but semantic ones (e.g., Ionin et al. 2006). For this reason, a more detailed semantic investigation of these measured gerunds is needed, with the hopes of demonstrating that, in a semantic as well as syntactic sense, large clausal nominalizations are truly quite nominal.

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Expanding the nominal in English nominalizations

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